



# Diwali (Deewali)

## दीपावली — प्रकाश का पर्व

### School Speech Collection · 7 Versions

Six speeches, one for every CEFR level (A1 to C2), with the level words in **red bold italic**, plus a seventh speech packed with **green bold phrasal verbs**. Each speech has an Introduction, Body and Conclusion, a vocabulary list with English and Hindi meanings, and a word count.

| Version   | Level                   | Words | Vocab items |
|-----------|-------------------------|-------|-------------|
| Version 1 | A1 – Beginner           | 272   | 14          |
| Version 2 | A2 – Elementary         | 306   | 12          |
| Version 3 | B1 – Intermediate       | 289   | 18          |
| Version 4 | B2 – Upper-Intermediate | 301   | 19          |
| Version 5 | C1 – Advanced           | 302   | 20          |
| Version 6 | C2 – Proficient         | 290   | 23          |
| Version 7 | Phrasal Verb Special    | 325   | 44          |

**A1****Version 1 · CEFR Level A1 – Beginner**

Very simple words and short sentences

Highlighted: **CEFR A1 words** (red, bold, italic)**INTRODUCTION**

Good morning, respected Principal, dear teachers and my friends. Today I want to talk about my favourite **festival**. It is Diwali. I am very **happy** to speak about it in front of you all.

**BODY**

Diwali is a big **festival** in India. It comes in October or November. People call it the **festival** of **light**. We are very **happy** on this day. Before Diwali, we **clean** our house. My mother and I **paint** the walls. We buy **new** clothes and **new** shoes. My father buys **sweets** and small gifts. The market is full of people. Every shop has **beautiful lamps** and bright **colours**.

**BODY**

On Diwali evening, we wear our **new** clothes. We put small **lamps** in front of the door. We draw a pretty rangoli on the floor. Then we sit together for **prayer** to Goddess Lakshmi. We ask God for a good life for everyone. After the **prayer**, we eat **sweets**. I love laddoo and barfi. At night, we go outside with our friends. We see many **colours** in the sky. But I do not like loud crackers. They are bad for animals and for the air. I only use small sparklers.

**BODY**

Diwali is not only for my family. We give **sweets** to our **neighbours**. We say **Happy** Diwali to everyone. Everybody smiles and everybody is **kind**. We also **share** food with poor people near our house.

**CONCLUSION**

In the end, Diwali is a **beautiful festival**. It teaches us that **light** is stronger than dark. Good is stronger than bad. Please be **kind**, **share** your **sweets** and keep the air **clean**. I wish you all a very **happy** and safe Diwali. Thank you.

**Word Count: 272 words**

## CEFR A1 Vocabulary – English &amp; Hindi Meanings

| #  | CEFR Word        | English Meaning                                       | Hindi Meaning (हिन्दी अर्थ) |
|----|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1  | <b>festival</b>  | a special day or time when people celebrate something | त्योहार / उत्सव             |
| 2  | <b>light</b>     | brightness that comes from a lamp, the sun, etc.      | रोशनी / प्रकाश              |
| 3  | <b>happy</b>     | feeling or showing joy                                | खुश / प्रसन्न               |
| 4  | <b>clean</b>     | free from dirt; to remove dirt                        | साफ़ / साफ़ करना            |
| 5  | <b>paint</b>     | to put colour on a wall or surface                    | रंगना / रंग-रोगन करना       |
| 6  | <b>new</b>       | not old; made or bought recently                      | नया                         |
| 7  | <b>sweets</b>    | small sugary foods, such as laddoo                    | मिठाइयाँ                    |
| 8  | <b>lamp</b>      | a small oil or electric light (diya)                  | दीपक / दीया                 |
| 9  | <b>prayer</b>    | words spoken to God                                   | प्रार्थना                   |
| 10 | <b>colour</b>    | red, green, blue, yellow, etc.                        | रंग                         |
| 11 | <b>neighbour</b> | a person who lives near you                           | पड़ोसी                      |
| 12 | <b>beautiful</b> | very nice to look at                                  | सुंदर                       |
| 13 | <b>kind</b>      | friendly and caring towards others                    | दयालु                       |
| 14 | <b>share</b>     | to give a part of something to others                 | बाँटना / साझा करना          |

**A2****Version 2 · CEFR Level A2 – Elementary**

Everyday words and clear, connected sentences

Highlighted: **CEFR A2 words** (red, bold, italic)**INTRODUCTION**

Good morning, respected Principal, honourable teachers and my dear friends. Today, I am very excited to speak about Diwali, the festival of lights. It is one of the happiest times of the year for me and my family.

**BODY**

Diwali is one of the most **popular** festivals in India. We **celebrate** it every year in October or November. It lasts for five days, and each day is **special**. People **believe** that Lord Rama came back to his city, Ayodhya, after fourteen years. The people of Ayodhya lit hundreds of small lamps to welcome him. That is why we light lamps on Diwali.

**BODY**

A few weeks before the festival, everyone starts to get ready. We clean our homes and **decorate** them with flowers and colourful lights. My sister makes a beautiful rangoli at the entrance. My mother cooks **delicious** food, and the whole house smells wonderful. We also go shopping, and my father buys a small **gift** for each of us.

**BODY**

On the main day, our family wears new clothes and prays to Goddess Lakshmi. Then we **invite** our friends and **relatives** for dinner. We eat sweets, laugh, play games and take many photos. In the evening, children enjoy **fireworks**, but we must be **careful**. Loud crackers can hurt people and frighten animals. I always ask my friends to use fewer crackers or just choose sparklers.

**BODY**

Diwali also teaches us important lessons. It shows that good always wins over **evil**. It tells us to help poor people and share our happiness. Last year, my class made cards and sent them to an old-age home. The elderly people were so happy, and we felt very proud.

**CONCLUSION**

To conclude, Diwali is a festival full of light, love and hope. Let us **celebrate** it safely and kindly. I wish you and your families a very happy Diwali. Thank you very much.

**Word Count: 306 words**

## CEFR A2 Vocabulary — English & Hindi Meanings

| #  | CEFR Word        | English Meaning                                    | Hindi Meaning (हिन्दी अर्थ)  |
|----|------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| 1  | <b>popular</b>   | liked or enjoyed by many people                    | लोकप्रिय                     |
| 2  | <b>celebrate</b> | to do something special for an important day       | जश्न मनाना / (त्योहार) मनाना |
| 3  | <b>special</b>   | better or more important than usual                | खास / विशेष                  |
| 4  | <b>believe</b>   | to think that something is true                    | विश्वास करना / मानना         |
| 5  | <b>decorate</b>  | to make a place look more beautiful                | सजाना                        |
| 6  | <b>delicious</b> | having a very good taste                           | स्वादिष्ट                    |
| 7  | <b>gift</b>      | something you give to someone as a present         | उपहार / तोहफ़ा               |
| 8  | <b>invite</b>    | to ask someone to come to an event                 | आमंत्रित करना / न्योता देना  |
| 9  | <b>relative</b>  | a member of your family                            | रिश्तेदार                    |
| 10 | <b>fireworks</b> | small explosives that make bright lights and noise | आतिशबाज़ी / पटाखे            |
| 11 | <b>careful</b>   | thinking about safety and avoiding mistakes        | सावधान / सतर्क               |
| 12 | <b>evil</b>      | very bad or cruel; wickedness                      | बुराई / दुष्ट                |

**B1****Version 3 · CEFR Level B1 – Intermediate**

Clear ideas, reasons and personal opinions

Highlighted: **CEFR B1 words** (red, bold, italic)**INTRODUCTION**

Good morning, respected Principal, teachers and my dear classmates. It is a great honour for me to speak about Diwali, the festival of lights, which is **widely** loved across India and in many other countries of the world.

**BODY**

Diwali is celebrated on the new-moon night of the Hindu month of Kartika. According to the Ramayana, Lord Rama **returned** to Ayodhya after **defeating** the demon king Ravana. The **citizens** welcomed him by lighting rows of clay lamps. Since then, the festival has **symbolised** the **victory** of good over evil and of knowledge over ignorance. In some regions, people also remember Lord Krishna's **defeat** of Narakasura, while others **worship** Goddess Lakshmi for happiness and wealth.

**BODY**

The preparations begin weeks earlier. Families clean and paint their homes, buy new clothes and **exchange** gifts. Markets are crowded and full of glowing lamps, flowers and sweets. On Diwali night, the whole neighbourhood has a warm and cheerful **atmosphere**. People **gather** to pray, share meals and forget their old **quarrels**. I still remember last year, when our neighbours came to our house and my grandmother told us stories about our **ancient customs**.

**BODY**

However, we should also think about the **environment**. Every year, firecrackers cause serious air **pollution** and disturb sick people, pets and small babies. That is why I **suggest** that we choose clay lamps, flowers and quiet celebrations instead. We can also **donate** sweets and clothes to poor families, because the real spirit of Diwali is to make someone else smile. It is our **responsible** duty as young **citizens**.

**CONCLUSION**

To sum up, Diwali is not just a holiday; it is a lesson about hope, kindness and togetherness. Let us celebrate it in a safe and **responsible** way. Thank you, and Happy Diwali to everyone.

**Word Count: 289 words**

## CEFR B1 Vocabulary – English & Hindi Meanings

| #  | CEFR Word          | English Meaning                                 | Hindi Meaning (हिन्दी अर्थ)    |
|----|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| 1  | <b>widely</b>      | by a large number of people or in many places   | व्यापक रूप से / बड़े पैमाने पर |
| 2  | <b>return</b>      | to come or go back to a place                   | लौटना / वापस आना               |
| 3  | <b>defeat</b>      | to win against someone; a loss or failure       | हराना / पराजय                  |
| 4  | <b>citizen</b>     | a person who lives in a city or country         | नागरिक                         |
| 5  | <b>symbolise</b>   | to represent an idea or quality                 | प्रतीक होना / दर्शाना          |
| 6  | <b>victory</b>     | success in a fight or competition               | विजय / जीत                     |
| 7  | <b>worship</b>     | to show respect to God through prayer           | पूजा करना / उपासना             |
| 8  | <b>exchange</b>    | to give something and receive something similar | आदान-प्रदान करना               |
| 9  | <b>atmosphere</b>  | the feeling or mood of a place                  | माहौल / वातावरण                |
| 10 | <b>gather</b>      | to come together in one place                   | इकट्ठा होना                    |
| 11 | <b>quarrel</b>     | an angry argument                               | झगड़ा / तकरार                  |
| 12 | <b>ancient</b>     | very old; from a long time ago                  | प्राचीन                        |
| 13 | <b>custom</b>      | a traditional way of behaving                   | रीति-रिवाज़                    |
| 14 | <b>environment</b> | the natural world around us                     | पर्यावरण                       |
| 15 | <b>pollution</b>   | dirty or harmful substances in air or water     | प्रदूषण                        |
| 16 | <b>suggest</b>     | to give an idea or advice                       | सुझाव देना                     |
| 17 | <b>donate</b>      | to give money or things to help others          | दान करना                       |
| 18 | <b>responsible</b> | sensible and trusted to do the right thing      | ज़िम्मेदार                     |

**B2****Version 4 · CEFR Level B2 – Upper-Intermediate**

Detailed arguments and more abstract ideas

Highlighted: **CEFR B2 words** (red, bold, italic)**INTRODUCTION**

Good morning, respected Principal, esteemed teachers and my dear friends. Standing before you today, I feel truly **privileged** to speak about Diwali, a festival whose **significance** goes far beyond dazzling lights and sweet treats.

**BODY**

Diwali, or Deepavali, **commemorates** the return of Lord Rama to Ayodhya after fourteen years of **exile**. Yet its meaning varies across regions: in the south it marks Krishna's victory over Narakasura, Jains observe it as the day Lord Mahavira attained liberation, and Sikhs connect it with Bandi Chhor Divas. This **diversity** shows how the festival **embraces** many beliefs under one sky of light.

**BODY**

The **spiritual** message is equally powerful. Each lamp we light **represents** our **determination** to drive out darkness, not merely from our streets, but from our minds, in the form of anger, jealousy and ignorance. The **rituals** of cleaning our houses and worshipping Goddess Lakshmi remind us that prosperity depends on discipline and purity of heart.

**BODY**

Diwali also **strengthens** social bonds. Families reunite, **communities** organise gatherings, and even strangers exchange warm wishes. The atmosphere is full of **enthusiasm**, and it encourages **generosity** towards the less fortunate. In my own family, we distribute food packets to workers who cannot travel home, and I can tell you that their smiles are the brightest lamps of all.

**BODY**

At the same time, we must be honest about the challenges. **Excessive** firecrackers **contribute** to dangerous air pollution and noise, harming children, the elderly and animals alike. I therefore urge each of you to adopt **sustainable** habits: use eco-friendly diyas, natural colours and reusable decorations, and spread **awareness** among your neighbours.

**CONCLUSION**

In conclusion, Diwali is a celebration of **unity**, hope and responsibility. If we let its message guide our daily behaviour, every day can become as bright as Diwali night. Thank you, and I wish you a safe and prosperous festival.

**Word Count: 301 words**

## CEFR B2 Vocabulary – English &amp; Hindi Meanings

| #  | CEFR Word            | English Meaning                                       | Hindi Meaning (हिन्दी अर्थ)       |
|----|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 1  | <b>privileged</b>    | having a special advantage or honour                  | सौभाग्यशाली / विशेषाधिकार प्राप्त |
| 2  | <b>significance</b>  | importance or special meaning                         | महत्त्व / अहमियत                  |
| 3  | <b>commemorate</b>   | to remember an important event with a ceremony        | स्मृति में मनाना / स्मरण करना     |
| 4  | <b>exile</b>         | being forced to live away from your home              | निर्वासन / देश-निकाला             |
| 5  | <b>diversity</b>     | a range of many different kinds                       | विविधता                           |
| 6  | <b>embrace</b>       | to accept and include willingly                       | अपनाना / समेट लेना                |
| 7  | <b>spiritual</b>     | connected with the soul and religion                  | आध्यात्मिक                        |
| 8  | <b>represent</b>     | to stand for or symbolise                             | दर्शाना / प्रतिनिधित्व करना       |
| 9  | <b>determination</b> | firm decision to achieve something                    | दृढ़ संकल्प                       |
| 10 | <b>ritual</b>        | a set of actions done as part of a religious ceremony | अनुष्ठान / रस्म                   |
| 11 | <b>strengthen</b>    | to make stronger                                      | मज़बूत करना                       |
| 12 | <b>community</b>     | a group of people living in one area                  | समुदाय / समाज                     |
| 13 | <b>enthusiasm</b>    | strong excitement and interest                        | उत्साह                            |
| 14 | <b>generosity</b>    | willingness to give freely to others                  | उदारता                            |
| 15 | <b>excessive</b>     | much more than is necessary or safe                   | अत्यधिक                           |
| 16 | <b>contribute</b>    | to help cause something or to give a share            | योगदान देना / कारण बनना           |
| 17 | <b>sustainable</b>   | not harming the environment for the future            | टिकाऊ / पर्यावरण-अनुकूल           |
| 18 | <b>awareness</b>     | knowledge and understanding of a subject              | जागरूकता                          |
| 19 | <b>unity</b>         | being joined together as one                          | एकता                              |



## Version 5 · CEFR Level C1 – Advanced

Fluent, precise and well-structured language

Highlighted: **CEFR C1 words** (red, bold, italic)

### INTRODUCTION

Good morning, respected Principal, distinguished faculty and my fellow students. It is both an honour and a pleasure to address you on Diwali, a festival that **embodies** the very essence of Indian civilisation.

### BODY

At its heart, Diwali is a celebration of **triumph**: the **triumph** of righteousness over wickedness, and of wisdom over ignorance. When Lord Rama returned to Ayodhya, the citizens lit countless lamps not merely to **illuminate** the night, but to express their **profound** joy at the restoration of justice. That story continues to **resonate** with us because every generation faces its own form of darkness, whether it is prejudice, greed or **indifference**.

### BODY

Diwali is also deeply linked to **prosperity**. Merchants open fresh account books, homes are cleaned **meticulously**, and Goddess Lakshmi is **invoked** with devotion. Yet the wisest interpretation of **prosperity** is not wealth alone; it is the **cultivation** of contentment, gratitude and **integrity**. A family may possess a great deal and still lack the peace that a single humble lamp can bring.

### BODY

What I **cherish** most about this festival is its power to build **solidarity**. Rich and poor, young and old, urban and rural, all gather in a spirit of shared **festivity**. Acts of **philanthropy** flourish during these days, and I believe such kindness **perpetuates** the true spirit of the occasion long after the last lamp has burned out.

### BODY

Nevertheless, a **conscientious** citizen must acknowledge the **ecological** cost of our celebrations. The smoke from firecrackers lingers for days, worsening respiratory problems and **undermining** public health. Celebrating responsibly, with clay diyas, flowers and community programmes, allows us to honour tradition without compromising the planet's future.

### CONCLUSION

To conclude, Diwali invites each of us to confront **adversity** with courage and to light a lamp of hope in someone else's life. May this festival **illuminate** your path with wisdom and warmth. Thank you.

**Word Count: 302 words**

## CEFR C1 Vocabulary – English &amp; Hindi Meanings

| #  | CEFR Word            | English Meaning                                       | Hindi Meaning (हिन्दी अर्थ)   |
|----|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 1  | <b>embody</b>        | to be a perfect example of an idea or quality         | साकार करना / मूर्त रूप देना   |
| 2  | <b>triumph</b>       | a great victory or success                            | विजय / जीत                    |
| 3  | <b>illuminate</b>    | to light up; to make clear                            | रोशन करना / प्रकाशित करना     |
| 4  | <b>profound</b>      | very deep and strongly felt                           | गहरा / गंभीर                  |
| 5  | <b>resonate</b>      | to strike a chord; to have a deep meaning for someone | मन में गूँजना / गहरा असर करना |
| 6  | <b>indifference</b>  | lack of interest or concern                           | उदासीनता                      |
| 7  | <b>prosperity</b>    | success and wealth                                    | समृद्धि / खुशहाली             |
| 8  | <b>meticulously</b>  | with great care and attention to detail               | बारीकी से / सावधानीपूर्वक     |
| 9  | <b>invoke</b>        | to call upon God or a spirit in prayer                | आह्वान करना                   |
| 10 | <b>cultivation</b>   | the development of a quality or skill                 | विकास / संवर्धन               |
| 11 | <b>integrity</b>     | honesty and strong moral principles                   | ईमानदारी / सत्यनिष्ठा         |
| 12 | <b>cherish</b>       | to value something deeply                             | संजोना / बहुत प्रिय मानना     |
| 13 | <b>solidarity</b>    | unity and support among people                        | एकजुटता                       |
| 14 | <b>festivity</b>     | joyful celebration                                    | उत्सव / धूमधाम                |
| 15 | <b>philanthropy</b>  | helping others by giving money or time                | परोपकार / दानशीलता            |
| 16 | <b>perpetuate</b>    | to make something continue for a long time            | क्रायम रखना / जारी रखना       |
| 17 | <b>conscientious</b> | careful and dutiful in doing what is right            | कर्तव्यनिष्ठ / ईमानदार        |
| 18 | <b>ecological</b>    | related to living things and their environment        | पारिस्थितिक / पर्यावरणीय      |
| 19 | <b>undermine</b>     | to weaken gradually                                   | कमजोर करना / नुकसान पहुँचाना  |
| 20 | <b>adversity</b>     | difficulty or misfortune                              | विपत्ति / कठिनाई              |

**C2****Version 6 · CEFR Level C2 – Proficient**

Sophisticated, elegant and nuanced expression

Highlighted: **CEFR C2 words** (red, bold, italic)**INTRODUCTION**

Good morning, respected Principal, distinguished guests, learned teachers and my beloved friends. I stand before you today with immense pride to speak about Diwali, the **quintessential** festival of light, a celebration so **ubiquitous** in the Indian imagination that it seems to **pervade** the very air we breathe.

**BODY**

Consider, for a moment, the **kaleidoscopic** spectacle of Diwali night: rooftops **resplendent** with flickering diyas, doorways adorned with intricate rangoli, and a sky ablaze with **incandescent** colour. Yet the true **luminosity** of this festival lies far beyond the visible. Diwali is the **epitome** of a philosophy which insists that light is not merely the absence of darkness, but a conscious, courageous act of creation.

**BODY**

The **ethos** of the festival is **transcendent**. It **juxtaposes** the fragile, trembling flame of a clay lamp against the vast darkness of the new-moon night, and quietly asserts that the smaller flame prevails. That idea is both humbling and **exhilarating**. Whether one recalls Rama's homecoming, honours Lakshmi, or remembers Mahavira's liberation, the underlying conviction remains **ineffable** yet universal: goodness, however modest, is **indomitable**.

**BODY**

Equally moving is the **benevolence** that this season awakens. Neighbours who barely spoke throughout the year exchange sweets with unaffected warmth, and the **magnanimity** of ordinary families towards those in need becomes **palpable**. Such **exuberance** of the heart is, I would argue, Diwali's most precious inheritance.

**BODY**

It would be **disingenuous**, however, to ignore the smog that now shrouds our cities after the festival. A tradition that claims to celebrate light must never **obscure** the sky. Let us therefore reimagine our **revelry**, choosing quieter, cleaner and more thoughtful forms of joy, so that a **propitious** future may inherit them.

**CONCLUSION**

In closing, may the light we kindle today **reverberate** in our conduct tomorrow. Thank you, and Shubh Deepawali.

**Word Count: 290 words**

## CEFR C2 Vocabulary — English &amp; Hindi Meanings

| #  | CEFR Word             | English Meaning                                   | Hindi Meaning (हिन्दी अर्थ)             |
|----|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| 1  | <b>quintessential</b> | the most perfect example of something             | सर्वोत्कृष्ट / आदर्श उदाहरण             |
| 2  | <b>ubiquitous</b>     | seen or found everywhere                          | सर्वव्यापी                              |
| 3  | <b>pervade</b>        | to spread through and be present in every part    | व्याप्त होना / छा जाना                  |
| 4  | <b>kaleidoscopic</b>  | full of many changing bright colours              | बहुवर्णी / रंग-बिरंगा                   |
| 5  | <b>resplendent</b>    | shining brilliantly and looking splendid          | देदीप्यमान / जगमगाता                    |
| 6  | <b>incandescent</b>   | glowing brightly with light                       | दीप्तिमान / प्रज्वलित                   |
| 7  | <b>luminosity</b>     | brightness; the quality of giving off light       | चमक / प्रकाशमानता                       |
| 8  | <b>epitome</b>        | a perfect example of a quality or type            | साकार रूप / प्रतिमूर्ति                 |
| 9  | <b>ethos</b>          | the guiding beliefs of a culture or group         | मूल भावना / लोकाचार                     |
| 10 | <b>transcendent</b>   | going beyond ordinary limits; above the everyday  | लोकोत्तर / सर्वोपरि                     |
| 11 | <b>juxtapose</b>      | to place two things side by side to show contrast | आमने-सामने रखकर अंतर दिखाना             |
| 12 | <b>exhilarating</b>   | making you feel very happy and excited            | उल्लासपूर्ण / रोमांचक                   |
| 13 | <b>ineffable</b>      | too great to be described in words                | अवर्णनीय                                |
| 14 | <b>indomitable</b>    | impossible to defeat or discourage                | अदम्य / अजेय                            |
| 15 | <b>benevolence</b>    | kindness and desire to do good                    | परोपकारिता / दयालुता                    |
| 16 | <b>magnanimity</b>    | generous and noble-minded behaviour               | महानुभावता / उदारता                     |
| 17 | <b>palpable</b>       | so strong that it can almost be felt              | स्पष्ट रूप से महसूस होने वाला           |
| 18 | <b>exuberance</b>     | lively, cheerful energy                           | उमंग / उल्लास                           |
| 19 | <b>disingenuous</b>   | not sincere; pretending not to know something     | कपटपूर्ण / अनुचित रूप से भोला बनने वाला |
| 20 | <b>obscure</b>        | to hide or make unclear                           | ढकना / धुँधला करना                      |
| 21 | <b>revelry</b>        | noisy, lively celebration                         | आमोद-प्रमोद / धूमधाम                    |
| 22 | <b>propitious</b>     | favourable; showing a good chance of success      | शुभ / अनुकूल                            |
| 23 | <b>reverberate</b>    | to echo; to have a lasting effect                 | गूँजना / दूर तक असर डालना               |

## 7

## Version 7 · Phrasal Verb Special

Maximum phrasal verbs in a natural speech

Highlighted: **Phrasal verbs** (green, bold)

## INTRODUCTION

Good morning, respected Principal, teachers and my dear friends. Today, let me **take you through** the story of Diwali, a festival we all **look forward to** every single year.

## BODY

Thousands of years ago, Lord Rama **set out** on a journey of fourteen years. He **gave up** his kingdom, **put up with** many hardships and **set off** for Lanka to rescue Sita. After the great battle, he **came back** to Ayodhya, and the people **lit up** the whole city with lamps. Ever since, we **carry on** this beautiful tradition.

## BODY

Weeks before the festival, we **clean up** our homes, **throw away** old junk and **do up** the rooms with fresh paint. My mother **takes out** her best decorations, and my father **puts up** colourful lights on the balcony. We **pick out** new clothes and **stock up on** sweets. Even the market **fills up** with cheerful crowds.

## BODY

On Diwali day, our relatives **drop in**, and we **sit down** together to eat. The elders **hand out** gifts while the children **dress up** in their finest clothes. In the evening, we **get together** on the terrace, **switch on** the fairy lights and **look up** at the glowing sky. Laughter **rings out** from every house, and nobody is **left out**.

## BODY

However, we must **cut down on** firecrackers. They **give off** harmful smoke, which can **bring on** breathing problems in children and old people. Let us **make up** our minds today to **switch over** to clay lamps and quiet celebrations, and let us **stand up for** our environment. If we **find out** that a neighbour is struggling, let us **reach out to** him, **share out** our sweets and **hand over** some warm clothes.

## CONCLUSION

To **wrap up**, Diwali **brings together** rich and poor, young and old. Whenever life **lets us down**, its light **cheers us up** and **keeps us going**. So **hold on to** its message, **pass it on** to your children and never **give in** to darkness. Thank you, and Happy Diwali!

Word Count: 325 words

## Phrasal Verbs — English & Hindi Meanings

| #  | Phrasal Verb                  | English Meaning                           | Hindi Meaning (हिन्दी अर्थ)   |
|----|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 1  | <b>take (someone) through</b> | to explain something step by step         | (किसी को) विस्तार से समझाना   |
| 2  | <b>look forward to</b>        | to wait for something with pleasure       | बेसब्री से इंतज़ार करना       |
| 3  | <b>set out</b>                | to begin a journey                        | यात्रा पर निकलना              |
| 4  | <b>give up</b>                | to stop having or doing something         | छोड़ देना / त्याग देना        |
| 5  | <b>put up with</b>            | to tolerate something unpleasant          | सहन करना                      |
| 6  | <b>set off</b>                | to start a journey                        | रवाना होना                    |
| 7  | <b>come back</b>              | to return                                 | वापस आना / लौटना              |
| 8  | <b>light up</b>               | to fill a place with light                | जगमगाना / रोशन करना           |
| 9  | <b>carry on</b>               | to continue                               | जारी रखना                     |
| 10 | <b>clean up</b>               | to make a place completely clean          | पूरी तरह साफ़ करना            |
| 11 | <b>throw away</b>             | to get rid of something you don't need    | फेंक देना                     |
| 12 | <b>do up</b>                  | to decorate or repair                     | सजाना / नया रूप देना          |
| 13 | <b>take out</b>               | to bring something out of a place         | बाहर निकालना                  |
| 14 | <b>put up</b>                 | to fix something in position; to hang     | लगाना / टाँगना                |
| 15 | <b>pick out</b>               | to choose carefully                       | चुनना / छाँटना                |
| 16 | <b>stock up on</b>            | to buy a large supply of something        | भरपूर मात्रा में ख़रीदकर रखना |
| 17 | <b>fill up</b>                | to become completely full                 | भर जाना                       |
| 18 | <b>drop in</b>                | to visit someone without a plan           | अचानक मिलने आ जाना            |
| 19 | <b>sit down</b>               | to take a seat                            | बैठ जाना                      |
| 20 | <b>hand out</b>               | to give to many people                    | बाँटना / वितरित करना          |
| 21 | <b>dress up</b>               | to wear special or smart clothes          | सज-धजकर तैयार होना            |
| 22 | <b>get together</b>           | to meet and spend time with others        | इकट्ठा होना / मिलना-जुलना     |
| 23 | <b>switch on</b>              | to turn on a light or machine             | चालू करना / जलाना             |
| 24 | <b>look up</b>                | to raise your eyes upward                 | ऊपर की ओर देखना               |
| 25 | <b>ring out</b>               | to sound loudly and clearly               | गूँज उठना                     |
| 26 | <b>leave out</b>              | to not include someone                    | छोड़ देना / शामिल न करना      |
| 27 | <b>cut down on</b>            | to reduce the amount of something         | कम करना / घटाना               |
| 28 | <b>give off</b>               | to send out smoke, light or smell         | छोड़ना / उत्सर्जित करना       |
| 29 | <b>bring on</b>               | to cause something (usually bad) to start | पैदा करना / शुरू कर देना      |

| #  | Phrasal Verb               | English Meaning                          | Hindi Meaning (हिन्दी अर्थ)     |
|----|----------------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 30 | <b>make up (your mind)</b> | to decide                                | (मन) बना लेना / निर्णय लेना     |
| 31 | <b>switch over</b>         | to change from one thing to another      | बदल लेना / अपना लेना            |
| 32 | <b>stand up for</b>        | to defend or support                     | पक्ष में खड़े होना / रक्षा करना |
| 33 | <b>find out</b>            | to discover a fact                       | पता लगाना                       |
| 34 | <b>reach out to</b>        | to offer help or contact to someone      | मदद का हाथ बढ़ाना               |
| 35 | <b>share out</b>           | to divide and give a part to each person | बराबर बाँटना                    |
| 36 | <b>hand over</b>           | to give something to someone             | सौंप देना                       |
| 37 | <b>wrap up</b>             | to finish or conclude                    | समाप्त करना / निष्कर्ष देना     |
| 38 | <b>bring together</b>      | to unite people                          | लोगों को एक साथ लाना            |
| 39 | <b>let down</b>            | to disappoint someone                    | निराश करना                      |
| 40 | <b>cheer up</b>            | to make someone feel happier             | मन प्रसन्न करना                 |
| 41 | <b>keep going</b>          | to help someone continue                 | आगे बढ़ते रहने की हिम्मत देना   |
| 42 | <b>hold on to</b>          | to keep and not let go                   | थामे रखना / संजोकर रखना         |
| 43 | <b>pass on</b>             | to give or tell to the next person       | आगे बढ़ाना / अगली पीढ़ी को देना |
| 44 | <b>give in</b>             | to surrender                             | हार मान लेना                    |